

Rests and ties

Rests and ties are two essential elements in music notation. Rests are used to notate silences within the music. Ties join two or more notes together to form a longer note.

SEE ALSO

◀ 24–25 Beats and measures

◀ 26–27 Note values

◀ 28–29 Beams and dots

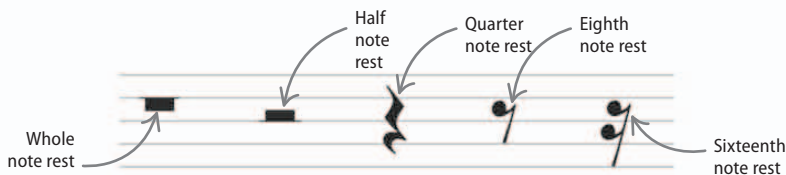
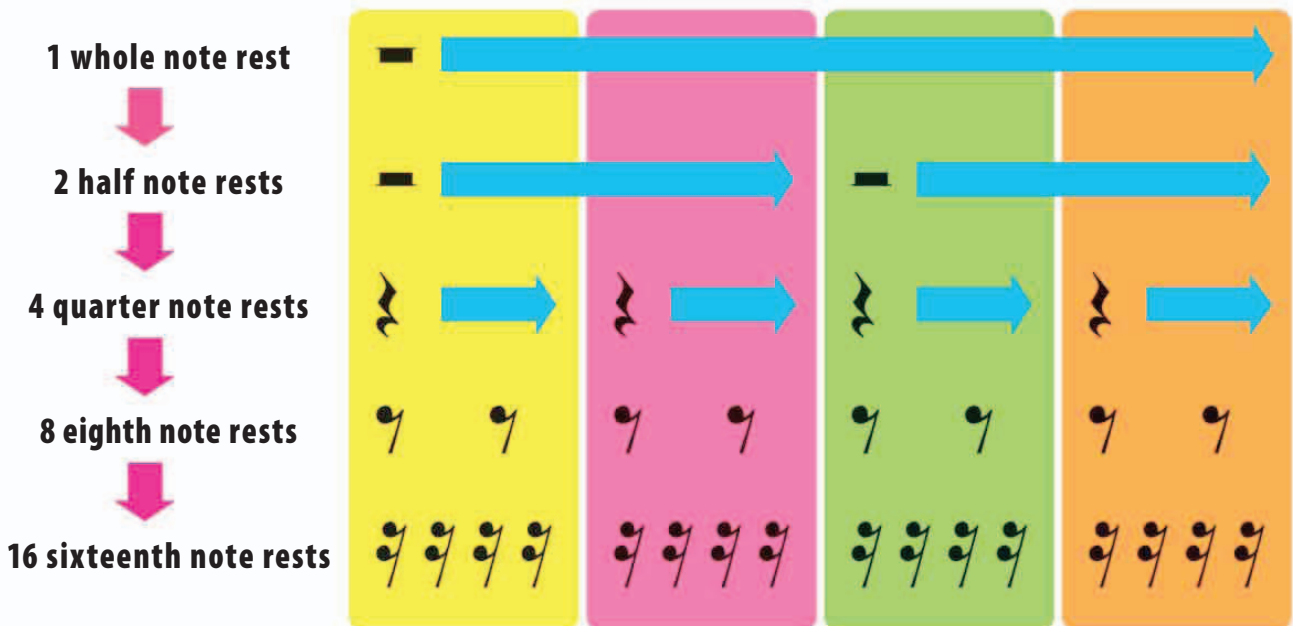
◀ 30–31 Time signatures

Gaps in the music

Rests assign a time value to silences—gaps in the music during which a player or singer does not produce any sound. They work just like notes and have the same time values. When playing or writing music, the rests are just as important as the notes.

▽ Rests

The flowchart below shows rests and how their time values relate to each other. It corresponds to the chart of note time values (see page 27).

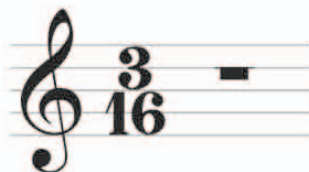


◁ On the staff

Here are the positions of all rests on the staff. A half note rest sits on a staff line, usually the third line from the bottom. A whole note rest hangs from a staff line, usually the second line down.

Whole measure rests

The symbol for the whole note rest is also used as a whole measure rest in any time signature. Whole measure rests are centered within the measure, not placed at the left-hand end.



◁ Whole measure rests in action

This example has a 3/16 time signature. The rest indicates silence for the whole measure, regardless of the meter.